

Increasing WLAN Security for Small Businesses © Interlink Networks, Inc.

Abstract

With the rapid adoption of WLAN technology and the growing pool of network vulnerabilities, small business IT managers and leaders have had to plan for additional security in order to support a mobile environment. Preparation comes with significant challenges. In addition to a multitude of confusing acronyms and multi-proprietary Wi-Fi protocol choices in the 802.11 security landscape, current security products do not adequately address the needs of the small business community. Solutions are expensive and entail a complex set-up process and specialized knowledge beyond the scope of many small business IT organizations. Compared to the security infrastructure typical of a large enterprise, small businesses have been “forced to settle for security that is flimsy at best” or defer deploying it altogether.

These factors lend to the belief that security and simplicity cannot co-exist in the same network security solution. Interlink Networks has created a technology that now makes this possible. This white paper addresses small business IT consultants, IT management generalists, early adopters and influencers, and security-conscious small business leaders. The document details how traditional solutions have failed to offer a specialized security resource for the small business market. First, it analyzes the WLAN market and its impact on the small business seeking to improve business efficiencies. Then it defines unique requirements essential to small businesses when investing in a security solution, further examining WLAN security challenges and traditional solutions. Finally it introduces a software solution developed by Interlink Networks that specifically addresses small business requirements for WLAN security issues. The document concludes that although small business practitioners have become increasingly sophisticated in their use of electronic information and their knowledge of computer-related vulnerabilities, they should not be required to invest in costly infra-